



## Want to be a hologram?

What really happens when you fall into a black hole.

<http://dgit.in/blackhlo>



## Beautiful spectrum

NASA's NuSTAR, Japan's Hinode spacecraft, and NASA's Solar Dynamics Observatory work together to map sun's energy spectrum. Read more: <http://dgit.in/amznsgsun>

Smart SoHo

and you believe in your product. Although we don't know yet whether your product is indeed great, we'll consider for the moment that it is. There's a misguided belief that a great product will market itself. Don't fall for it. A consumer will buy only what he knows. Unless you have a plan to bring your product or service to the consumer's notice, it's not going to be sold. You also need to be able to convince them why they need it.

In the course of researching this article, we had the opportunity to speak to Vinay Rao, CTO of Venture Factory. His company does something quite interesting – it can be thought of as a production line for creating ventures with factory-like quality processes that aim to eliminate flaws in startups at a very early stage. Vinay has himself invested close to \$10 million as an angel investor in various startups. He aptly says, "Entrepreneurs shouldn't forget fundamentals. It's super important to find a product that sells and a product that makes money rather than just customer acquisition".

### Form your core team

Last but not the least, we need to consider the core team. A startup is driven by its founders and employees. Their skills,

### THE GEEK WAY TO MASTER BUSINESS PLANS

We're geeks. We're Google wizards. And we're pro-convenience (not lazy). As it turns out, there are several online repositories available with tons of readymade business plans across verticals that you can tailor to your needs. Follow this shortlink for one such site: <http://dgit.in/bplan4all>

You can also download templates here: <http://goo.gl/UMzVPt> and <https://goo.gl/YIEuxk>.

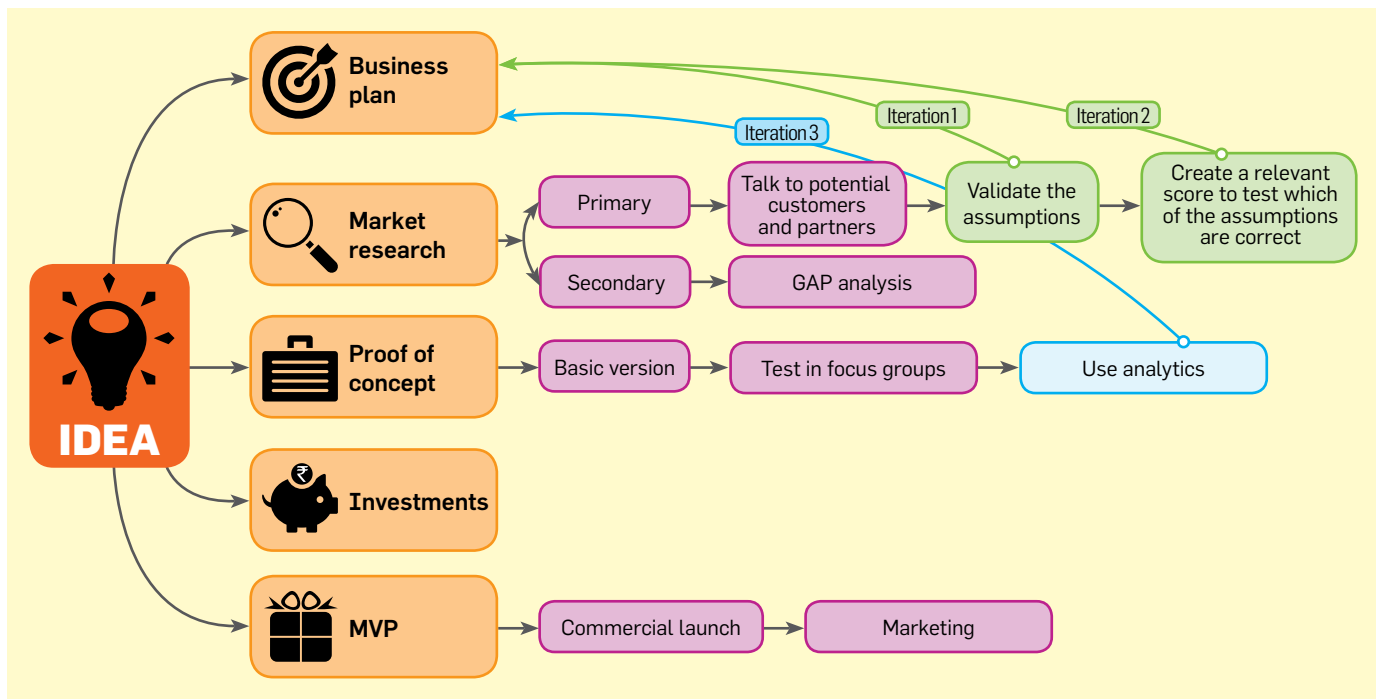
expertise, determination and commitment is directly proportional to the startup's success. Be sure to find a Watson to your Holmes. You may be a deadshot like the Sundance Kid, but you need a Butch to lead the team. If you're looking for a co-founder and technology is your niche, you don't necessarily need to look for someone with non-technical skills only. They can maybe complement your skills or knowledge areas like Wozniak and Jobs or Larry and Sergey. Form a team, whose calibre covers all the major aspects of your business. An ideal composition would be a strong leader, a technical expert, sales and

marketing guy and a number cruncher. While building your team think of an HR strategy, the culture you want to develop and the attributes you're looking for in an employee. Be careful with selecting team members. Look for someone who will stick with you through the bumpy parts, not abandon ship at the first sign of trouble.

### Research – Do your homework

#### Learn about the competition

Do a Google News search on your industry and read every article you can lay your hands on. It's the most effective way to hack secondary research. Slowly, you'll have a bird's eye view of the market and be able to better understand how it works. The main part of your industry research will be studying your competitors. Even if you've created a unique product, you're most likely providing a substitute to another product/service. E.g. personal computers were unique, but they were a substitute to typewriters, calculators and a host of other devices. Or look at the 'Hövdung' helmet (<http://dgit.in/hov-wtchvid>) – despite how extraordinary the idea is, it replaces the traditional helmet. In the words of marketing guru Al Ries, you're creating a new category or using



The iterative process of making a perfect business plan